

from Bangalore. The teacher notified me of an error in one of Prem's assignments, and then went on to reprimand me for the same. I listened to everything she had to say, came back home, and cried my heart out," she narrates.

Reflecting on that incident, years later, Chitra wishes that she could spend more time with her son, now with roles reversed. "All I wanted for him was to get into a good professional engineering course!" she exclaims. Prem completed his post graduation from Barcelona Supercomputer Centre and followed his mother's footsteps of building chips by joining Intel. Currently he is working with NVIDIA, which is driving the advancements in artificial intelligence chips.

Iron lady

Her entrepreneurial journey shifted to the next gear when the team of Dr Naveed Sherwani and Dr Satya Gupta, who earlier started Intel Microelectronics, decided to move out of Intel and build a new fabless semiconductor start-up Open-Silicon supported by Pierre Lamond of Sequoia and Promod Haque of NVP. Once again, Chitra faced the tough decision of leaving a fast-progressing career at the largest and most prestigious semiconductor company and joining a startup. Sticking to her guiding philosophy, "Don't wait for things to change and get better, become the change and make things better," Chitra took on the challenge to build a brilliant silicon design



Happy family 2023

Three Proud Moments for Chitra

1. Building Open-Silicon; Winning the Best Design Team Award
2. Building Google's first Pixel Phone SoC
3. Indigenous Smart Parking solutions Installation for Intel

team at a successful semiconductor chip startup.

Building and leading a silicon engineering team in a chip startup with global ambitions was challenging but Chitra remembers them as the most satisfying six years of her career. With venture capitalists monitoring every move with a hawk's eye, Chitra's inherent nature to be on top of every aspect of the project and customer requirements allowed her to have on-time chip tape-outs and first-time silicon success. As a founding member in Open-Silicon, she was part of more than 100 chip tape-outs. Her diligence, project execution, and customer management earned her the nickname of 'Iron Lady' from Promod Haque of NVP.

Open-Silicon triggered multiple unique engagements with leading Indian universities, especially with IIT Madras. She recalls her conversations with Prof. Kamakoti of RISE Labs and reveals how her dynamic work ethic was appreciated by him. "Till date Kama calls me Tiger, because of my vigour in the work place!"

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